



Class apart: Having won the treble with Barcelona nearly a decade ago, Luis Enrique's arrival brought high hopes to PSG. REUTERS

In his first year, the coach tried to get the club's blue-eyed boy Mbappe to buy into his vision. In a video of one of his individual sessions with the star forward, Enrique's mandate was quite evident: play as a unit, no matter what your position is.

"... you think you have to score goals for us. Of course, you're a phenomenon. No doubt about that. But that's not enough for me. A true leader is one who, when they can't help with goals, helps in everything (else) that matters," he was seen telling the Frenchman.

However, after a semifinal exit last year, Mbappe eventually got his dream move to Real Madrid.

PSG's front three now comprises Khvicha Kvaratskhelia, Ousmane Dembele (**right**) and Doue, whose combined transfer fees of €170 million stands less than what the club paid for Mbappe alone.

Dembele, once deemed one of the brightest youngsters in Europe, spent 784 days on the sidelines at Barcelona and struggled with off-field issues, including a video game addiction. It led to the Catalans offloading him.

The winger then revived his career in the French capital. In 2025, Dembele made 33 goal contributions

(25G, 8A), more than any player across the top five leagues of Europe, also winning the UCL Player of the Season award.

Doue, on the other hand, was substituted within 18 minutes of coming on for Rennes in a 1-3 loss to Lyon in 2023 — an incident that sparked doubts about his first-team chances. "It does not mean I don't have great trust in him and that he'll fail to make a great career, but some things need to be understood faster," Rennes' manager Bruno Génésio had said. In the final, Doué became the first player to have three or more goal contributions (2G, 1A) and won the UCL Young Player of the Season award.

UCL final strategy

Enrique's advice to Mbappe became Dembele's gospel in the final — he hustled, harried, and though he didn't score, he assisted twice.

Inter, which played with long balls — starting with the goalkeeper Yann Sommer passing it to the full-backs — was cornered



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